一夜之间换边开车

The Night Sweden Switched Sides



全国换边行驶，怎样在一个清晨完成?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In a 1955 referendum, about 83 per cent of voters chose to keep driving on the left, an overwhelmingly clear rejection of change. On 10 May 1963, however, legislators in parliament overruled the electorate, approving right-hand traffic from 1967 in defiance of a populace among whom the plan was unpopular.

The case rested on conformity. Norway and Finland drove on the right, with about five million border crossings a year, so a left-hand orientation meant isolation and inconvenient journeys. Safety favoured alignment too. About 90 per cent of cars were left-hand drive, so motorists overtaking on narrow two-lane highways risked head-on collisions.

A state body ran the mammoth preparation under a logo, a large H with an arrow. Its propaganda included a song contest on television, and the winning jingle, whose lyrics urged people to keep right, reached fifth in the chart. Some 360,000 items of signage were changed, and a massive fleet of over 1,000 new buses with right-hand doors was procured.

The transition came on Sunday 3 September 1967. A curfew kept non-essential vehicles off the asphalt from one to six, with essential traffic exempt. At ten to five, all traffic stopped and crawled across, restarting at five, before dawn, with its direction flipped. Stockholm and Malmö had a longer closure, from Saturday morning to Sunday afternoon, while crews reconfigured junctions.

On the following Monday, 125 accidents were reported, against 130 to 198 on earlier Mondays, a statistical improvement put down to the heightened care of hesitant drivers. The nervousness apparently subsided and prudent habits faded, for by 1969 accident and fatality rates had reverted to their baseline.

中文译文

1955年瑞典举行公投，约83%的投票者选择保留靠左行驶，以压倒性多数拒绝改变。然而，1963年5月10日，议会推翻选民的选择，不顾这项计划在民众中缺乏支持，批准自1967年起改为靠右行驶。

改制的理由是与邻国统一。挪威和芬兰都靠右行驶，每年约有500万次跨境通行，瑞典靠左便带来隔阂和出行不便。安全也支持统一：约90%的汽车方向盘位于左侧，司机在狭窄的双车道公路上超车时，容易面临迎面相撞的危险。

一个国家机构负责这项庞大的准备工程，以带箭头的大写H为标识。宣传还包括电视歌曲比赛，获胜的广告歌用歌词劝人靠右行驶，甚至登上歌曲排行榜第五名。约36万件道路标识被更换，1000多辆右侧开门的新公交车也采购到位。

切换在1967年9月3日星期日进行。凌晨1点至6点，非必要车辆不得上路，必要车辆获得豁免。4点50分，仍在路上的车辆全部停下，再缓缓移到另一侧；5点、天亮之前，车辆统一按相反的行驶侧重新出发。斯德哥尔摩和马尔默的封路时间更长，从周六上午到周日下午，施工人员在此期间改造交叉路口。

随后的星期一报告了125起事故，此前的星期一则有130至198起。这一统计上的改善，被归因于司机对新制度尚不熟悉，开车格外小心。紧张感似乎后来消退了，谨慎习惯也随之淡去：到1969年，事故率和死亡率已回到原来的基准水平。

左侧方向盘与靠左行驶不是一回事；首个周一事故少，并不意味着长期事故率持续下降。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

referendum n.
全民公投
a 1955 referendum

legislator n.
立法者
legislators in parliament

overrule v.
推翻（决定或意见）
overruled the electorate

electorate n.
全体选民
overruled the electorate

in defiance of 介词短语
不顾；违抗
in defiance of a populace

conformity n.
一致；统一
The case rested on conformity

isolation n.
孤立
meant isolation

alignment n.
统一；保持一致
Safety favoured alignment too

overtake v.
超车
motorists overtaking

head-on collision n.
迎头相撞
risked head-on collisions

preparation n.
准备工作
the mammoth preparation

signage n.
各类标识
360,000 items of signage

procure v.
采购；取得
was procured

transition n.
转变；过渡
The transition came on Sunday

exempt adj.
获豁免的
with essential traffic exempt

reconfigure v.
重新设置；改造
crews reconfigured junctions

statistical adj.
统计上的
a statistical improvement

put … down to … 动词短语
把……归因于……
put down to the heightened care

subside v.
消退
The nervousness apparently subsided

prudent adj.
谨慎的
prudent habits faded

revert to 动词短语
回到；恢复到
had reverted to their baseline

baseline n.
基准水平
reverted to their baseline

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共34项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

overwhelmingly adv.
压倒性地

rejection n.
拒绝

parliament n.
议会

populace n.
民众

unpopular adj.
不得人心的

orientation n.
行驶侧；通行取向

inconvenient adj.
不便的

motorist n.
驾车者

lane n.
车道

highway n.
公路

mammoth adj.
庞大的

logo n.
标识

arrow n.
箭头

propaganda n.
宣传

contest n.
比赛

jingle n.
广告短歌

lyric n.
歌词

chart n.
歌曲排行榜

massive adj.
巨大的

fleet n.
车队

curfew n.
车辆限行令

non-essential adj.
非必要的

asphalt n.
沥青路面

crawl v.
缓慢移动

dawn n.
黎明

flip v.
翻转；改变方向

closure n.
封闭

junction n.
交叉路口

improvement n.
改善

heightened adj.
增强的

hesitant adj.
犹豫不决的

nervousness n.
紧张

fade v.
逐渐消失

fatality rate n.
死亡率

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In a 1955 _____, about 83 per cent of voters chose to keep driving on the left, an overwhelmingly clear rejection of change.

02 Some 360,000 items of _____ were changed, and a massive fleet of over 1,000 new buses with right-hand doors was procured.

03 A curfew kept non-essential vehicles off the asphalt from one to six, with essential traffic _____.

04 The nervousness apparently subsided and prudent habits faded, for by 1969 accident and fatality rates had reverted to their _____.

文章主线

- 缘由 瑞典靠左，挪威和芬兰靠右，过境车流频繁；瑞典九成汽车的方向盘又在左边，窄路超车有迎面相撞风险。
- 决定 1955年公投约83%反对改靠右，议会仍于1963年批准改制，定在1967年实施。
- 准备 政府广泛宣传，更换约36万件道路标识，购置1,000多辆右侧开门的公交车，并在切换期间限制非必要车辆上路。
- 切换 1967年9月3日4点50分，车辆停下后缓缓移到另一侧，5点统一靠右出发；部分城市另封路改造路口。
- 后续 切换后首个周一事故减少，被归因于司机格外谨慎；但到1969年，事故率和死亡率都回到原有水平。

参考答案　1 referendum 2 signage 3 exempt 4 baseline